Sai Teja K

DevOps / Platform Engineer | Kubernetes & OpenShift | Terraform | CI/CD | DevSecOps | AWS & Azure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- DevOps engineer with 5+ years building delivery platforms in regulated industries: energy (NextEra Energy), payments (JPMorgan Chase) and telecom (Verizon).
- At NextEra, designed the Terraform, Harness and Vault approach used to move outage-management and meter-data services off on-prem servers that could not scale during storms. Releases went from after-hours downtime windows to zero-downtime deploys, and P1/P2 incidents dropped about 35%.
- Build security into the pipeline instead of adding it at the end: scan gates that fail builds, secrets in Vault rather than config files, and pipeline output that serves as SOX, PCI-DSS and NERC CIP audit evidence.
- Standardize delivery across teams: wrote the shared Azure DevOps YAML templates adopted by 40+ payments services at JPMorgan Chase, and led the move off legacy Jenkins for 5 application teams.
- Own production operations: day-to-day Kubernetes and OpenShift administration, SLO-based alerting routed to PagerDuty, and post-incident RCA reviews. Mentor junior engineers and take production changes through ServiceNow CAB.
- Automate repetitive operations work with Ansible, Python and Bash: server builds cut from a full day to under 2 hours, about 15 engineering hours a week saved, and AWS costs down 18% through right-sizing and S3 lifecycle policies.
- Hands-on with EKS, AKS, OpenShift, Helm, Jenkins, Harness, Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions. Currently building an MCP server for LLM-assisted incident triage.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD & Release: Jenkins, Harness, Tekton (OpenShift Pipelines), GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Azure DevOps Pipelines (YAML), Argo CD (GitOps), Maven, Gradle, JFrog Artifactory, Nexus

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (modules, remote state, workspaces), AWS CloudFormation, ARM Templates, Ansible (playbooks, roles, Tower/AWX)

Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Red Hat OpenShift (OCP), Amazon EKS, Azure AKS, Helm, Istio

Cloud: AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, S3, EKS, ECS, ECR, Lambda, RDS, KMS, Secrets Manager, Route 53, Auto Scaling, ELB, CloudWatch, Systems Manager, SNS, SQS); Azure (AKS, Virtual Machines, Key Vault, Monitor, Virtual Network, Load Balancer)

DevSecOps: SonarQube, Snyk, Checkmarx, BlackDuck, Trivy, HashiCorp Vault, Azure Key Vault, IAM/RBAC least privilege, SSL/TLS, Security Groups, NACLs; SOX, PCI-DSS, NERC CIP

Observability & SRE: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Splunk, AppDynamics, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, PagerDuty, SLO-based alerting, RCA

Languages & OS: Python, Bash, PowerShell, YAML, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL), Go and Java (working knowledge); RHEL 7/8/9, Ubuntu, Amazon Linux, Windows Server

Source Control & Process: Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, GitFlow and trunk-based branching; ServiceNow, Jira, Confluence, CAB change management, Agile/Scrum

AI Tools: GitHub Copilot, LLM-assisted log analysis, Model Context Protocol (MCP)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NextEra Energy | Juno Beach, FL **Aug 2024 – Present**

DevOps Engineer

Grid Operations Platform Modernization: moving outage-management and meter-data microservices from on-prem RHEL servers to AWS EKS and Red Hat OpenShift.

- The on-prem servers behind outage management could not scale during storms and outage spikes, which is when the services are under the most load. Designed and proposed the move to EKS and OpenShift, then migrated 25+ microservices with Helm and Tekton, using HPA and Auto Scaling so capacity grows with demand. There was no customer-facing downtime during cutover.
- Replaced the manual, after-hours release window (about 4 hours, with downtime) with Harness canary and blue-green deployments that roll back automatically on failed health checks. Releases now go out with zero downtime in under an hour.
- Proposed and built the Terraform layout: reusable modules for VPC, EKS, IAM and RDS, with S3 remote state and DynamoDB locking. Dev, QA and prod are built from the same code, and manual provisioning effort is down about 60%.
- Application credentials were stored in plaintext config files. Moved them into HashiCorp Vault with dynamic credentials and automated SSL/TLS certificate renewal, which closed the related NERC CIP audit findings.
- Built Jenkins and GitHub Actions pipelines that block deploys on SonarQube quality gates, Snyk dependency scans and Trivy image scans. Failed deployments fell 40%.

- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and CloudWatch with SLO-based alerts routed to PagerDuty, and lead post-incident RCA reviews. Together with the autoscaling and release changes, this cut P1/P2 incidents by about 35%.
- Run the Kubernetes and OpenShift clusters day to day (namespaces, quotas, HPA, rolling updates, pod, network and storage troubleshooting). Wrote Ansible roles and Python/Bash scripts for RHEL patching, log rotation and health checks, saving about 15 engineering hours a week.
- Mentor 3 junior engineers on Terraform, Kubernetes and pipeline standards, and take production changes through ServiceNow CAB with development and QA.

Environment: AWS (EKS, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, DynamoDB), OpenShift, Terraform, Harness, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Tekton, Helm, Vault, SonarQube, Snyk, Trivy, Prometheus, Grafana, PagerDuty, Ansible, Python, Bash

JPMorgan Chase **Mar 2023 – Jul 2024**

DevOps Engineer

Payments Platform CI/CD Standardization: consolidating build and release for card-payments and treasury microservices onto Azure DevOps, AKS and OpenShift.

- Wrote the shared multi-stage Azure DevOps YAML templates that 40+ Java and .NET payments services adopted, and led the move off legacy Jenkins jobs for 5 application teams (runbooks in Confluence). Every team got the same build, scan and deploy stages, and deployment failures fell 25%.
- Made SonarQube, Checkmarx and BlackDuck scans a required stage in every pipeline, failing builds on critical vulnerabilities or license issues. The scan results became the evidence used in SOX and PCI-DSS audits.
- Worked with InfoSec to remediate 200+ infrastructure and container vulnerabilities and supported quarterly security assessments.
- Provisioned AKS, Virtual Networks, Key Vault, load balancers and Azure Monitor with Terraform, cutting environment setup time by 40%. Packaged services as Helm charts for AKS and OpenShift, and handled rolling updates and scaling for payments workloads.
- Set GitFlow branching, pull request policies and release tagging across 6 teams, so every production release could be traced back to reviewed, tagged code.
- Added latency and error-rate alerts in Prometheus, Grafana, Splunk and Application Insights to speed up incident triage, and automated routine admin with PowerShell and Bash.

Environment: Azure DevOps, AKS, OpenShift, Terraform, Helm, SonarQube, Checkmarx, BlackDuck, Splunk, Prometheus, Grafana, Application Insights, Java, .NET, PowerShell

Verizon **Jan 2021 – Jun 2022**

Cloud Engineer

Network Analytics Cloud Migration: moving internal network-analytics and reporting applications from data-center VMs to AWS.

- Right-sized EC2 instances and added S3 lifecycle policies, reducing compute and storage costs by 18%.
- Wrote Ansible playbooks and shell scripts to standardize server builds, cutting new server setup from a full day to under 2 hours.
- Containerized legacy Java applications with Docker and set up Jenkins builds with Maven and Nexus, the team's first working CI pipelines.
- Added CloudWatch alarms with SNS notifications, cutting incident response time by 30%. Handled Linux patching, backups and disaster-recovery validation.

Environment: AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, S3, RDS, CloudWatch, SNS), Ansible, Docker, Jenkins, Maven, Nexus, Bash, Linux

PROJECTS

Secure GitOps Delivery Platform on AWS

- Reference platform covering the full path from commit to cluster. Terraform provisions the VPC and EKS cluster. Jenkins builds, tests and scans images before pushing them to ECR, and Argo CD syncs Helm releases from Git, so what runs in the cluster always matches the repo.
- Secrets are injected at runtime by the Vault Agent Injector instead of living in images or manifests. Istio enforces mTLS between services, and Grafana tracks latency, traffic, errors and saturation.

Tools: Terraform, AWS EKS, ECR, Jenkins, Argo CD, Helm, HashiCorp Vault, SonarQube, Trivy, Istio, Prometheus, Grafana

AI-Assisted Incident Triage with MCP *(in progress)*

- Gives on-call engineers one place to ask "why is this pod restarting?": a Python MCP server exposes Kubernetes events, Prometheus metrics and recent logs to an LLM, which returns the relevant evidence and suggested runbook steps.

Tools: Python, Model Context Protocol (MCP), LLM, Kubernetes API, Prometheus API

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Developer – Associate | Amazon Web Services Oct 2024 – Oct 2027

Master of Science in Computer Science | Lewis University, Romeoville, IL